Project Brief – Erasmus Student Guide (TUL)

Submitted version: commit `2788fcb`

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Repository: https://github.com/EnginCelalYurt/erasmus_student_guide
Prototype: https://incomparable-dango-1e5aae.netlify.app/

1. Project canvas

Problem	Practical information for new Erasmus students is spread across university pages, USOS, ESN and social media groups, partly in Polish. Students who know the answers leave, and their knowledge is lost.
Users	Incoming Erasmus students at Lodz University of Technology (readers) and current TUL Erasmus students (writers).
Task	Settle in: complete arrival steps, find their way around Łódź, choose Learning Agreement courses.
Solution	A student-powered guide: TUL students share course reviews, guides and tips; the most helpful content rises to the top (Wilson score).
Existing alternatives	TUL / International Office pages: official, but no student experience. Facebook / WhatsApp groups: fast, but unstructured and answers get buried.
MVP journey	A current student signs in with a TUL e-mail → shares a review or guide → an incoming student finds it by search or category → votes it helpful → helpful content rises.
Main screens	Courses · Course detail · Łódź guide · Share · Planner (saved courses, ECTS, arrival checklist)
Out of scope	Other universities · official TUL single sign-on (USOS) · admin panel (moderation = posts with at least 5 votes and more not-helpful than helpful votes are hidden automatically) · push notifications · offline mode · desktop layout

2. Evidence and assumptions

Evidence: Peer prototype review by another team (`docs/Erasmus_Prototype_Feedback_Report.docx`): the arrival checklist and local information were rated useful; search scope, missing action feedback and data errors were reported.

Assumptions (not verified): Current students will write reviews and guides voluntarily. Student reviews help more than official course descriptions when choosing courses.

How we challenged them: AI review showed that "likes − dislikes" ranking is misleading (1/0 beats 30/1), so we use the Wilson score. Peer feedback kept the checklist in scope and moved the desktop layout out of scope.

3. User stories

US-1 Find guides and experiences. As an incoming Erasmus student, I want to browse guides and experiences shared by TUL students, so that I can prepare for my first weeks without searching many sources.

- ☐ Content can be filtered by category (Dormitories, Transport, Emergency, Student Life).
- ☐ Posts can be sorted by "Most helpful" (Wilson score) and "Newest"; 30 helpful / 1 not helpful ranks above 1 / 0.
- ☐ Reading does not require signing in.

US-2 Share my experience. As a current TUL Erasmus student, I want to sign in with my TUL e-mail and share a review, guide or tip, so that future students benefit from what I learned.

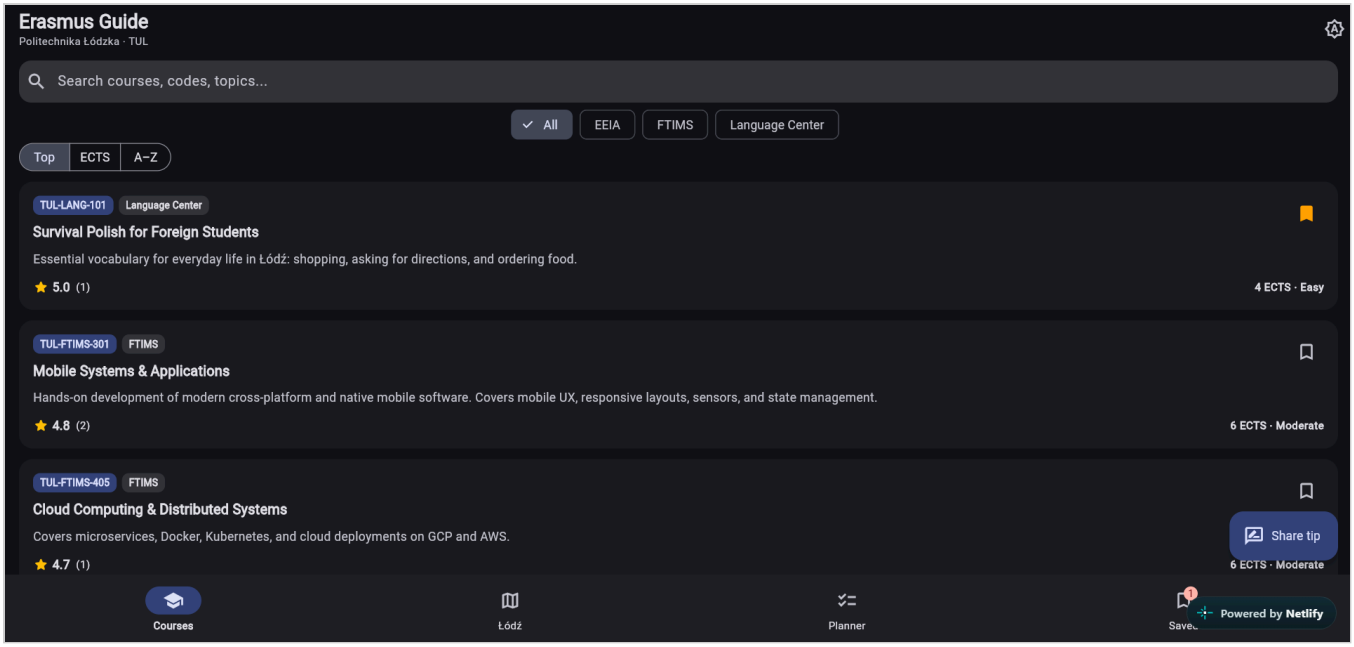
- ☐ Only TUL e-mail addresses can sign in; other addresses see an error message.
- ☐ Text shorter than 15 characters shows a validation message.
- ☐ A published post appears for other users.

US-3 Course reviews. As an incoming Erasmus student, I want to read other students' reviews of TUL courses, so that I can choose my Learning Agreement courses with more confidence.

- ☐ Searching "mobile" shows only courses whose name or code contains "mobile"; no results shows "No courses found".
- ☐ Tapping a course shows its reviews and average rating.
- ☐ A signed-in user can vote a review helpful / not helpful once.

4. Prototype

Interactive prototype: https://incomparable-dango-1e5aae.netlify.app/



5. Target platform

Android phones (mobile first), built with Flutter. A Flutter web build is used to share the prototype for testing. iOS and desktop layouts are not targeted in the MVP.

6. Accessibility requirements

1. **Readable text and contrast:** All text and buttons meet WCAG AA contrast (4.5:1) in the dark theme, and screens stay usable at 200% system font size.
2. **Meaningful labels:** Every icon-only button (bookmark, clear search, vote, map) has a descriptive TalkBack label, e.g. "Bookmark Mobile Systems & Applications".

7. Data and risk inventory

Data	Source	Stored	Note
TUL e-mail address	User, at sign-in	Firebase Authentication	Personal data; used only to verify TUL students, never shown
Nickname	User	Firebase database	Optional, shown with posts
Reviews, guides, tips	Users	Firebase database	Public to all readers
Helpful / not-helpful votes	Users	Firebase database, linked to user ID	Only totals are shown
Course list	Team, from public TUL information	App / database	Sample data until verified
Saved courses, checklist	User	On the device only	Not shared

No interview or personal research data is collected.

Risk	Mitigation
Not enough students write content (cold start)	Team writes the first content from its own experience
Firebase is new for the team	Build sign-in and one shared collection first, then extend
Wrong or outdated information	Voting; low-rated posts are hidden automatically, so moderation works without the team
Personal data (e-mail)	Store only what sign-in needs; delete an account on request

8. Responsibilities

Done so far: Yusuf Taskin – Flutter prototype (Netlify) · Engin Yurt – repository, README, project brief

Member	Implementation (~10 h)	Tests (~3 h)	Also
Yusuf Taskin	Peer-feedback fixes + guide/tip sharing form	His screens	Push prototype code to the repository
Aldiyar Kairolla	Firebase setup, TUL e-mail sign-in, database structure	Sign-in flow	Confirm TUL e-mail domain
Engin Yurt	Helpful / not-helpful voting, Wilson ranking with unit tests, automatic hiding of low-rated posts	Acceptance tests for all stories	Brief, pull-request workflow, submissions

Priorities: Must: sign-in, shared course reviews, voting with Wilson ranking. Should: guide/tip sharing, automatic hiding. Could: planner and checklist updates.